

Classification Level
Public
Internal
Confidential
Restricted (PHI / Highly Sensitive Clinical Data)

Data Classification Matrix

Description
Information approved for public release with no risk if disclosed.
Non-sensitive operational information intended for internal use only.
Sensitive business or operational information that could cause harm if disclosed.
Highest-sensitivity data including PHI and critical clinical information.

Examples (Healthcare-Specific)

Website content, public health brochures, job postings.

Staff schedules, internal memos, training materials, non-sensitive IT notes.

HR files, internal financials, vendor contracts, audit logs, system backups.

EHR data, lab results, diagnostic images, treatment plans, billing data with identifiers, prescriptions, clinical notes, and

Impact if Compromised

None.

Minor operational disruption; reputational inconvenience.

Financial loss, operational disruption, reputational damage.

Legal penalties, regulatory violations, patient safety risk, severe reputational damage.

Required Protection Level

No special controls; standard access allowed.

Basic access control; internal sharing only.

Encryption recommended; access restricted to authorized staff; logging required.

Mandatory encryption, MFA, strict least-privilege access, monitoring, secure storage, restricted sharing.